Tim McMackin

timothymcmackin@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/timothymcmackin
https://timothymcmack.in

Summary

I explain complicated large-scale computer platforms in plain language.

I build sample applications and implement docs-as-code pipelines.

I document AI features and make developer documentation readable by AI agents.

Experience

Webflow (Remote): **Staff Technical Writer** **Feb-May 2026 (workforce reduction)**

- Led a developer research project and reworked the developer documentation information architecture based on the results.
- Restructured the internal system that publishes documentation, SDKs, and API specs.
- Increased the success rate of MCP server sessions from 30% to 80% by reworking technical docs to be AI-readable, documenting the MCP server itself, and providing a documentation MCP server. This doc MCP server became the third most popular MCP tool.
- Tripled usage of beta features by documenting API updates and AI and non-AI-based features including generating updates to the Webflow Designer API via AI.

TriliTech (Remote): **Senior Technical Writer** **2023–2026**

- Updated the developer documentation for the Tezos blockchain, including API and SDK reference, tutorials, and developer-focused tasks.
- Documented domain-specific programming languages based on OCaml, Python, and JavaScript/TypeScript and wrote sample frontend and backend applications.
- Documented the Tezos Etherlink Ethereum compatibility layer and how to develop and use decentralized Solidity applications on it.
- Documented the Tezos SDK for Unity video game development tooling.

Shutterstock (Remote): **Staff Information Engineer IV** **2022**
Senior Information Engineer **2017–2022**

- Drove a culture of information sharing and introduced technical documentation processes as Shutterstock's first technical writer. Development teams adopted these processes and started their own documentation workgroups.
- Documented Shutterstock's public API, SDK, CLI, UI widgets, and AI tools.
- Reduced average partner integration time from 3 to 1.2 months.
- Developed a modular documentation platform that internal teams use to publish docs. Onboarded documentation for 5 internal services in 2 months and eventually 13 systems.

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Experience

IBM (Durham, NC):

Advisory Technical Writer/Team Lead:	2012-2017
Staff Technical Writer/Team Lead:	2007-2012
Technical Writer:	2004-2007

– Led a seven-person documentation team for IBM's UrbanCode continuous delivery software, including reference docs, live training, videos, white papers, customer forum response, and support response. Covered a wide range of enterprise DevOps scenarios, such as blue–green deployments, rolling deployments, dark launches, and continuous delivery.

– Documented a wide range of technologies and platforms, including programming languages, distributed software, mainframe software, mobile software, and cloud systems.

– Collaborated with support teams to identify customer needs and to focus efforts on preventing support calls. Reduced average time to documentation error resolution from 8 days to 2 days.

– Contributed to products at a technical level by writing code samples, coding progressive disclosure information, installing Jenkins pipelines, and implementing enhancements to product information in Java, JavaScript, and Python.

– Researched and wrote custom documents for large customers and critical needs, including videos, white papers, and topology models that were tailored to customers' specific situations. Contributed directly to sales deals in the millions of dollars.

Education

M.A. Professional and Technical Writing
Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA

B.A. English Rhetoric and Literature
Xavier University, Cincinnati, OH

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Publication samples

SmartPy language documentation

This documentation for the SmartPy smart contract programming language needed improvements to make it clearer to programmers coming from more traditional programming environments. I did a full reorganization and rewrite of the language reference manual.

Shutterstock API, SDK, and CLI reference

I originally built this API reference documentation with Widdershins and Shins but later wrote a custom Node.JS and Nunjucks program to generate it with the help of the API development team. It merges handwritten examples and task–based information about using the API with generated examples and endpoint reference from an OpenAPI source file.

By providing clear and thorough information for partners using the Shutterstock API, these reference docs reduced the average partner integration time from 3 months to 1.2 months.

Documentation for the Tezos SDK for Unity

This documentation provides the quickest possible route for experienced Unity game developers to use Tezos as their backend. It starts with a quickstart and leads users into task-based tech docs and reference for the SDK objects. I researched and wrote all of the content.

Tutorial: Licensing and downloading images with the Shutterstock free API subscription

This tutorial covers the end–to–end process of searching, licensing, and downloading images with a free API subscription, requiring no credit card or other prerequisites. It covers what the API can be used for, how our partners use it, and how it provides licensed images. The tutorial includes instructions for Postman, cURL, the Shutterstock CLI, and the Shutterstock JavaScript SDK. I researched and wrote all of the content.

Performance characteristics of IBM UrbanCode Deploy

I planned, wrote, and typeset this white paper based on testing data from our product development teams. I consulted with the performance testers about what the test results meant and with the customer–facing teams that needed to explain the performance of the product to current and potential customers.

Rollback scenarios in IBM UrbanCode Deploy

This video addresses customer confusion that I learned about from support requests.
It demonstrates techniques for reversing problems automatically, and it teaches customers about a common misconception about the product at the same time. Our internal support call analysis showed significantly fewer customer issues in this area after I delivered and promoted the video. I researched, wrote, and recorded the video.